

NOTICE OF INTENT TO AWARD SOLE SOURCE

The United States Air Force (the Government) intends to issue a Firm-Fixed-Price Purchase order to a single source, Aerol LLC., under the authority of FAR 13.106-1(b)(1)(i) (only one source reasonably available) on or about 05 March 2025. The period of performance (PoP) shall be from 05 March 2025 – 04 August 2025.

FSC: 2330

NAICS: 332999

Size Standard: 750 employees

Supplier name: Aerol LLC

Product description: Department of Defense (DoD) requires Running Gear System, MQ-1 Trailer Fabrication.

Product characteristics an equal item must meet to be considered:

Interface:

- The running gear shall attach independently to each corner interface of the trailer
- The system shall not have any axle or part that connects wheel axles between sides except the steering linkage parts.
- The tow bar shall attach to a separate interface on the front of the trailer frame and provide the side-to-side pivot necessary to operate the steering system.
- The overall running gear width when installed on the 22.00 IN-wide aft end of the trailer shall not exceed 55.32 IN to the outside of the tires. The overall running gear width when installed on the 28.00 IN-wide front (steering) end of the trailer shall not exceed 61.32 IN to the outside of the tires.
- The wheelbase length shall be 186.0 IN.
- The running gear must attach to the outboard surfaces of the trailer frame, which has a width of 22.00 IN.
- Each wheel (one per corner) shall be bolted to a vertically oriented mounting plate.

Suspension:

- Each wheel must have a minimum suspension travel of 1.625 IN.
- Each wheel must incorporate a coil spring type suspension.
- The running gear shall be equipped with four 6.00-9 x 10 ply pneumatic tires.

Steering:

- The running gear shall incorporate Ackerman type automotive steering.
- The minimum inside cramping angle shall be 40°.

Load Bearing:

- The running gear shall sustain a gross vehicle weight rating (GVWR) of 6200 LB, with weight equally distributed among the four wheels.
- The running gear shall sustain a downward static load factor of 4.5 G at GVWR, which is required for aerial delivery in fixed-wing aircraft (per MIL-STD-1791D(1), Par. 5.3.3.1 and Table IV).

Towing:

- The running gear shall sustain towing (at GVWR) at 25 MPH on paved surfaces and 15 MPH on unimproved, firm surfaces.
- The running gear shall have a tow bar that is a minimum of 80.00 IN long.
- The tow bar shall pivot 90° upward for stowage purposes.

Aircraft Transportation:

- No part of the running gear shall contact the aircraft ramp transitions during loading and unloading on the C-17, C-130, and C-5 aircraft.
- The running gear shall sustain a downward static load factor of 4.5 G at GVWR, which is required for aerial delivery in fixed-wing aircraft (per MIL-STD-1791D(1), Par. 5.3.3.1 and Table IV).

Braking:

- The brakes shall conform to the requirements of SAE AS8090 par. 3.6.1., 3.6.1.1., and 3.6.1.2.
 - The parking brakes shall be either the automotive type with internal expanding shoe, proper backing plates, and drum, or the automotive disc type. The brakes shall be applied by means of four, independently operated manual controls (hand levers), with one lever at each wheel to lock the wheels against rotation. Hand lever shall not exceed 18 inches in length from the pivot point, and brake actuation forces shall not exceed 200-pound inches.
 - Parking brake performance: The parking brakes shall lock the wheels so that the wheels will skid and not roll on dry, level, brushed concrete free of loose material when the vehicle, at GVWR, is subjected to a towing force sufficient to move it. The vibrations and shocks encountered on the applicable operating surfaces shall not cause the brakes to engage. Moving force shall be applied in both the forward and reverse directions. The parking brakes shall hold the vehicle, at GVWR, whether headed up or down an 11.5° incline.
- All necessary cables, actuator handle, fittings, etc. shall be integrated into the four bolt-on wheel assemblies.

Swivel Locking Wheels:

- The wheel assemblies shall swivel independently, about a vertical axis, a full 90 degrees toward their respective ends of the trailer and then lock into place to allow direct sideways movement of the trailer. The aft (non-steering) wheels shall swivel and lock in the neutral (0 degree) and aft-ward (-90 degree) positions. The forward (steering) wheels with steering linkage removed shall swivel and lock in the forward (+90 degree) position.

This notice of intent is not a request for competitive quotations. However, all responsible sources may submit a capability statement, proposal, or quotation, which shall be considered by the Government. The Government will consider responses received within 5 days of issuance of this notice. Information received will normally be considered solely for the purpose of determining whether or not to conduct a full and open competitive procurement or a small business set aside competitive procurement. The Government will not pay for any information received in response to this announcement.

If the Government decides to compete this requirement, a synopsis shall be issued utilizing the combined synopsis/solicitation procedure identified in FAR 12.603. If this effort becomes a Small Business Set-Aside, FAR 52.219-14, Limitation on Subcontracting, will apply. Therefore, small businesses that want to be considered for a small business set-aside should demonstrate how they intend to comply.

A determination not to compete this requirement based upon responses to this notice is solely within the discretion of the Government.

Contractors should be aware of the following information:

1. Contractors must include the following information:
 - a. Points of contact, addresses, email addresses, phone numbers.
 - b. Identification as a large U.S. business, a small U.S. business, or a foreign business. Please note that size indicated should be based on the NAICS code for this effort listed above.
 - c. Identification of any other socioeconomic status including Women-Owned Small Business, Economically Disadvantaged Small Business, 8(a), Service-Disabled Veteran Owned Small Business, Veteran Owned Small Business or HUBZone.

- d. Company CAGE Code or Unique Entity Identifier Number.
2. If this posting specifically references brand name products, offerors are encouraged to suggest products other than those specifically referenced. Responses must address how the alternate product meets the product characteristics specified above.
3. Submitted information shall be UNCLASSIFIED.
4. Responses are limited to 10 pages in a Microsoft Word compatible format.

Responses should be emailed to Samantha Ekberg at samantha.ekberg@us.af.mil and Andrew Petersen at andrew.petersen.3@us.af.mil no later than 10 March 2025, 2:00 PM EDT. Any questions should be directed to Samantha Ekberg through email.

Andrew J. Petersen
Contracting Officer
AFLMCM/PZIEB